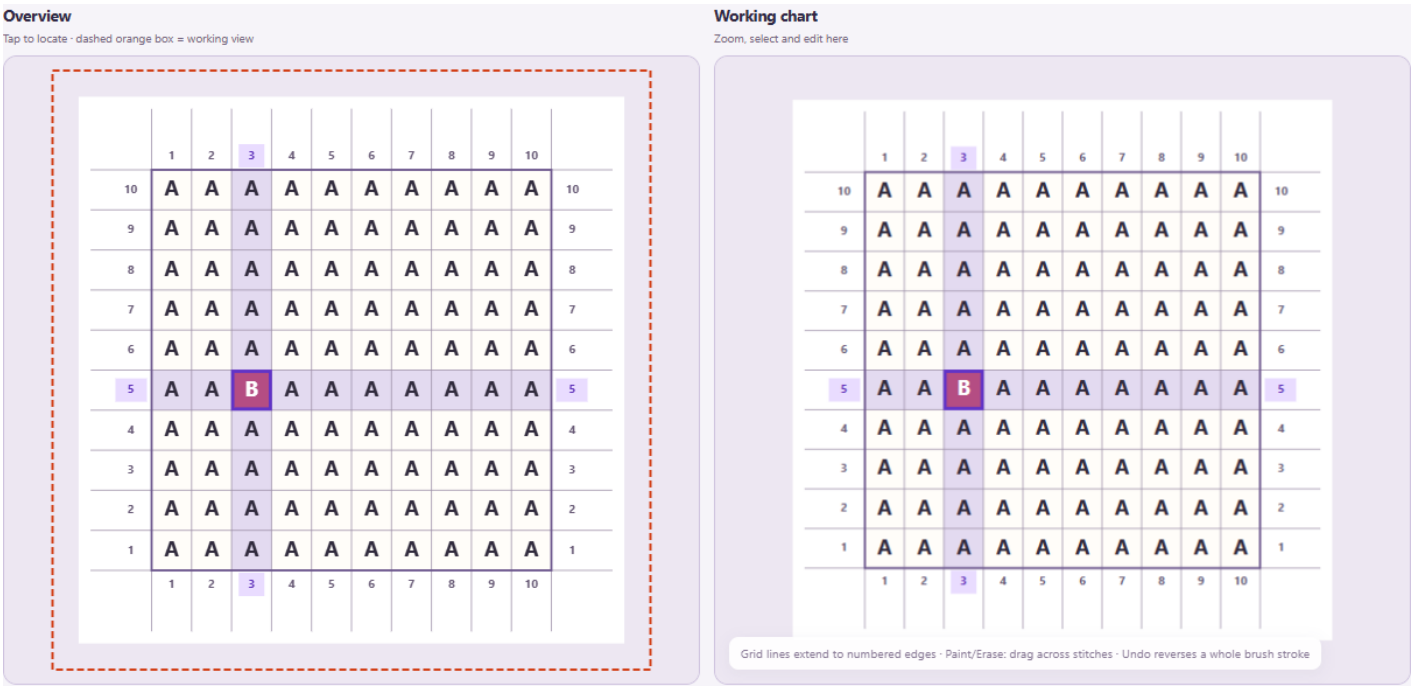
Dorette Crochet Studio

Illustrated user guide - Version 1.1.0

Create a stitch chart, edit yarn colors, follow your crochet one stitch at a time, and keep portable backups of your work.



Quick start

1. Open a project or create a practice chart.
2. Choose your yarn colors and edit the working chart.
3. Set the row direction and follow the inline guide.
4. Back up your projects as ZIP files.

The two charts are synchronized views of one project. The overview stays fitted while the working chart can zoom in. Your work stays in your browser; ZIP backups are your portable copy.

Screenshots use a small practice chart. Your project names, colors and layout may differ. This guide describes application controls, not a particular crochet stitch technique.

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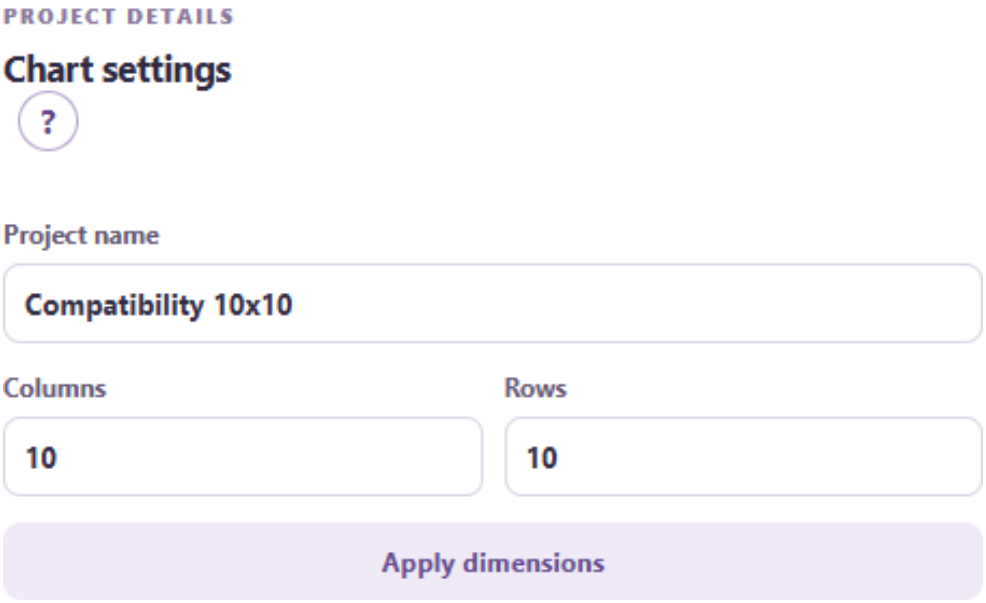
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Tap a title to jump there. PDF bookmarks provide the same navigation.

Start a project and save your work



Your projects
The Projects panel lists charts saved in this browser. Select a project to open it. Expand **New crochet project**, enter a name, columns and rows, then choose Create project. The supported range is 1-200 columns and 1-300 rows.

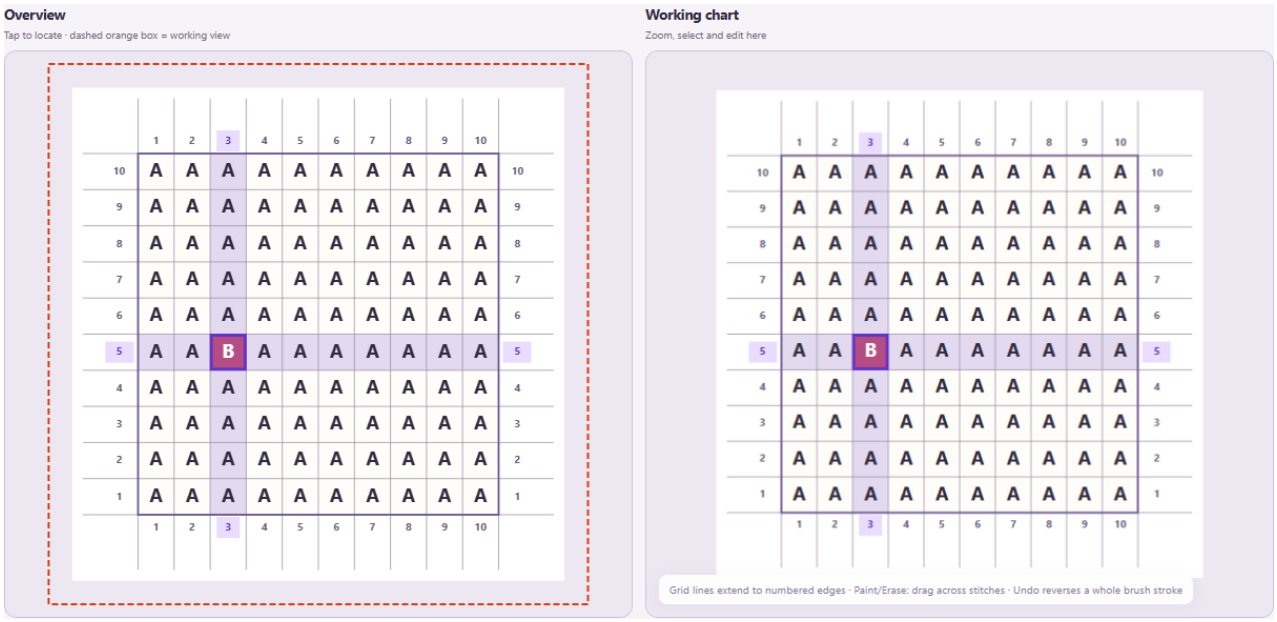
Names and sizes
Use Chart settings to rename the current project. To resize it, enter dimensions and choose Apply dimensions. The confirmation explains that stitches outside the new size are removed. Row 1 stays at the bottom. Back up first; Undo is available after resizing.

Autosave
Watch the save message at the top. A successful save says Saved on this device. Projects belong to the browser, device and website address you used. They do not automatically travel to another device or Google Drive.

Keep a portable copy
Back up all creates a ZIP containing your projects. Store a copy privately in Google Drive. If saving is blocked or fails, export a backup before leaving the page. See Saving and ZIP backups later in this guide.

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Use the synchronized charts



One chart, two views

The left Overview always fits the whole chart. The right Working chart is where you zoom, select and edit. Both draw the same project data: painting, progress, stitch selection, row/column highlights and selected areas appear in both.

Locate a stitch

Tap the overview to select a stitch and center the working chart there. Drag across the overview to explore. It navigates rather than painting, so you can keep the full chart useful as a map. The orange dashed rectangle shows the working viewport; it is a viewing aid, not a selected area.

Zoom and pan

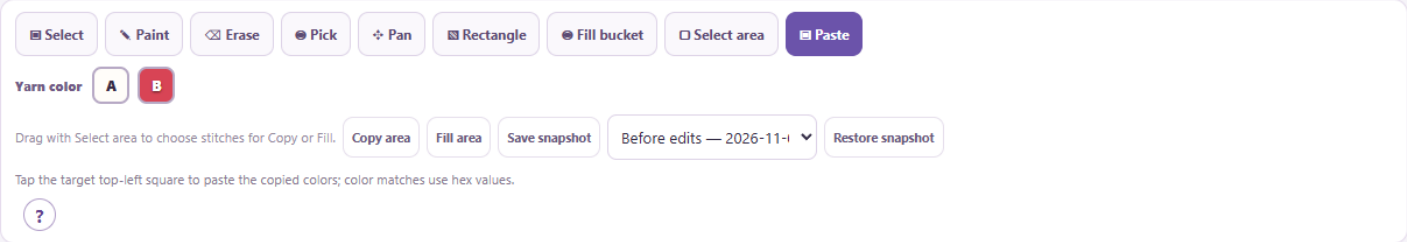
Use + and - above the chart, a mouse wheel, or a two-finger pinch on the working chart. Choose Pan and drag to move it. Fit chart fits the right-hand chart; Center recenters it at the current zoom. Zooming the right chart never zooms the overview.

Read the edges

Row 1 is at the bottom; column 1 is at the left. Selecting column 3, row 5 highlights both numbered edges in both views. At a small scale some labels are skipped for space, but the selected row and column remain labeled. Arrow keys move a selection on a focused chart.

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Paint and edit stitches



Basic tools

Select inspects a stitch. **Paint** uses the chosen yarn color as you tap or drag. **Erase** restores the first palette color, which is the chart background. **Pick** samples a yarn from a stitch. **Pan** moves the working view.

Rectangle and bucket

Choose **Rectangle** and drag between opposite corners to fill a rectangular region. **Fill bucket** changes the connected region of the tapped color. On a large background this may affect many stitches; use Undo immediately if the result is unwanted.

Selected areas

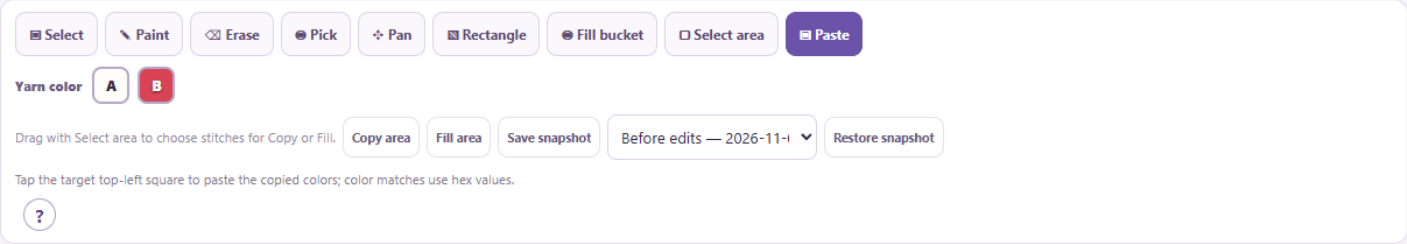
Choose **Select area** and drag across the desired stitches. **Fill area** fills that selection with the chosen yarn. **Copy area** copies its colors. Choose **Paste**, then tap the destination using its top-left stitch as the anchor. Stitches beyond the chart edge are clipped.

Undo and redo

Undo reverses an editing action, including an entire brush stroke. Redo reapplies it. Keyboard shortcuts are Ctrl+Z and Ctrl+Shift+Z. Undo history is for the current session; use snapshots and ZIP backups for recovery after closing the app.

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Snapshots and safe experimentation



Save a checkpoint

Before changing lettering, filling a background or trying a new palette, choose **Save snapshot** and give it a useful name such as Before lettering edits. Each project retains up to three snapshots; saving another drops the oldest.

Restore a checkpoint

Choose a saved entry from the snapshot list and select Restore snapshot. Confirm only after reading its message. The earlier chart, palette, progress and yarn information return; current changes are placed in Undo history.

What snapshots are for

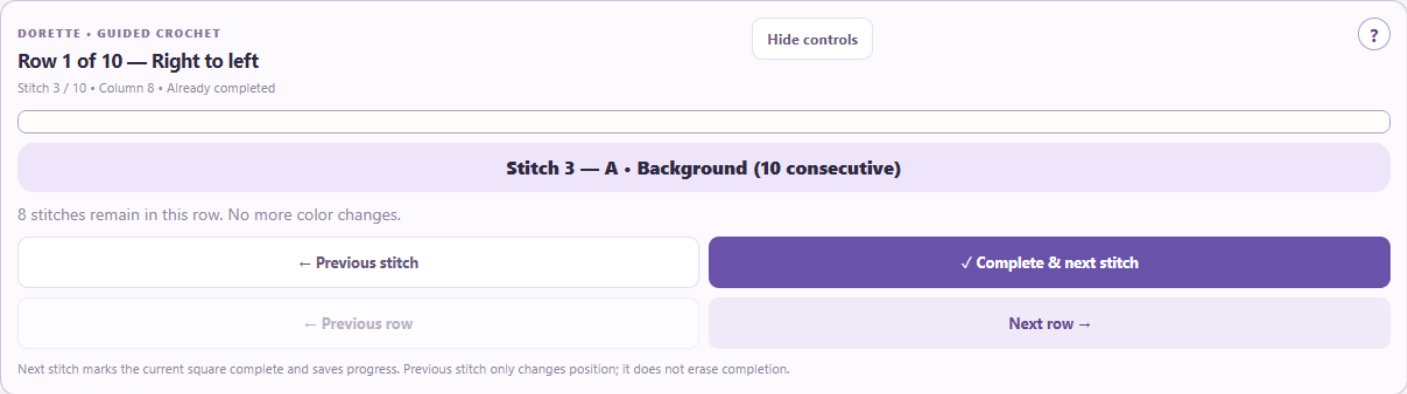
Snapshots preserve a stage of editing within the project and are included in its ZIP backup. They are not a substitute for a separate ZIP file: if browser site data is removed, the project and its internal snapshots can be lost together.

Practice first

Create a separate 10 x 10 chart. Add two yarns, paint a few squares, save a snapshot, fill an area, then restore. Try copy/paste and Undo/Redo here before using the tools on an important design.

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Crochet with the inline guide



Start or resume

The Guided Crochet panel appears directly below the charts, without a blocking window. It shows row, direction, stitch position, physical column, current yarn and the next color change. The color stripe summarizes the row.

Complete a stitch

Choose **Complete & next stitch** after making the indicated stitch. It marks that stitch complete and advances in the configured direction. At the end of a row it moves to the next row. At the final stitch it reports that the chart has finished.

Move without erasing progress

Previous stitch moves back but does not unmark completed work. Previous row and Next row move to the start of the neighboring row. Use Mark stitch or Mark row in Current selection when you need to change completion marks.

Stay oriented

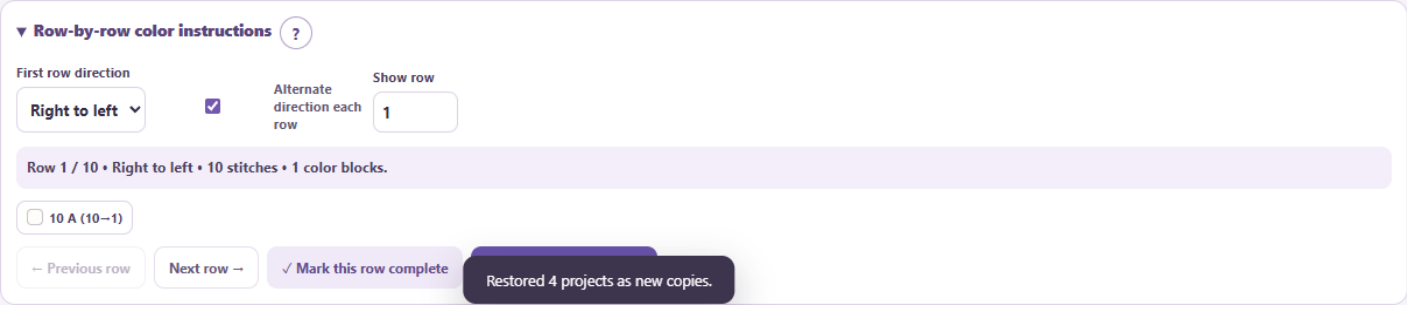
The selected stitch and its row/column highlights appear in both charts. If guided navigation moves outside the working view, the app centers it again. Guide position and progress autosave, including after reload.

Hide and reopen

Hide controls collapses the panel. Choose Guided Crochet Mode in Row-by-row color instructions to reopen it and focus the saved guided stitch. Selecting or painting elsewhere does not change the saved guide position.

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Read row-by-row instructions



Choose a working direction

Set First row direction to Right to left or Left to right. Enable Alternate direction each row if your technique reverses direction between rows. These choices drive the row instructions, guided mode and written-pattern PDF.

Choose a row

Enter Show row, use Previous row / Next row, or select a stitch in the chart. The chips show consecutive yarn counts in the order you will work them. Yarn letters match the legend.

Example

A bottom row with four B, three C and three A stitches from left to right is worked as **3 A, 3 C, 4 B** when the row direction is right to left. For left to right, the sequence is **4 B, 3 C, 3 A**.

Mark a whole row

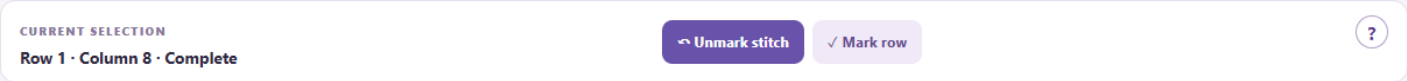
Mark this row complete toggles progress for that row. Whole-row progress counts every stitch in the row once. To remove a single completed mark inside a fully marked row, unmark the row first, then adjust individual stitches.

Colorwork instructions

These instructions tell you which yarn color to use. They do not prescribe crochet stitch type, turning chains, increases or finishing. Choose the correct direction and stitch technique for your pattern.

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Track selection and completion



Current selection

Tap a working-chart stitch with Select, or tap the overview, to inspect its row and column. The Current selection bar shows the coordinates and whether that stitch is complete. Green shading represents completed work; purple highlights show your selection.

Mark and unmark

Mark stitch toggles the selected stitch. Mark row toggles all stitches in its row. The labels change to Unmark when applicable. Individual completion and row completion are combined without counting stitches twice.

Selection versus guide

The chart selection is where you are inspecting or editing. The guided position is where Guided Crochet Mode will resume. To return to it, choose Guided Crochet Mode. Progress marks do not change yarn colors.

Progress totals

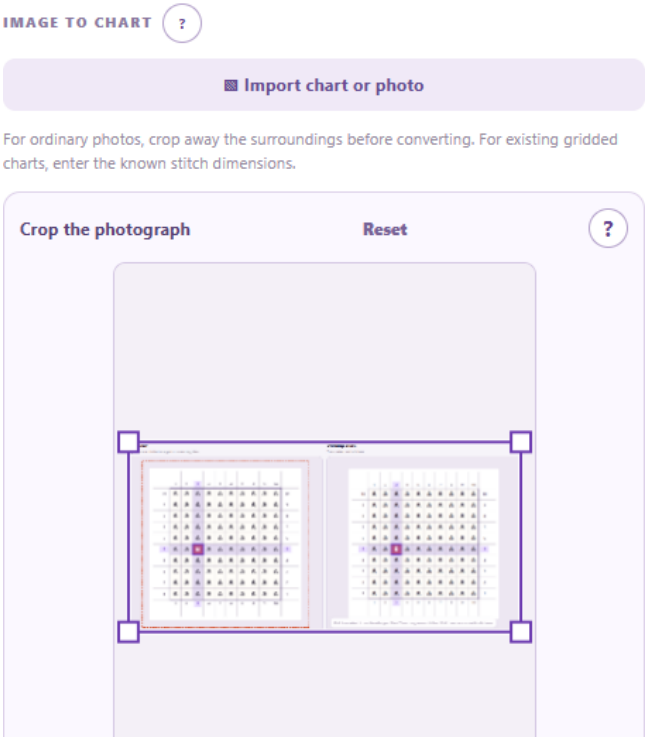
Stitch progress in the settings panel shows completed stitches, total stitches and percentage. Both charts show the same progress. The printable PDF can optionally include completed marks.

Correcting mistakes

If only your completion mark is wrong, use Unmark stitch or Unmark row. If the yarn color is wrong, use Paint, Erase or Undo. Always verify row and column before making the change.

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Import, crop and convert images



Import a source
Choose Import chart or photo and select an image. For a photograph, crop away unnecessary surroundings before conversion. For an existing gridded chart, enter the known stitch dimensions. A saved chart can be edited without reattaching its original photo.

Crop precisely
Drag the purple corner handles, or use the Trim left/right/top/bottom sliders and percentage boxes. Reset restores the full image. The T-shirt preset is a starting point only. Image placement controls how the crop fits the chart area.

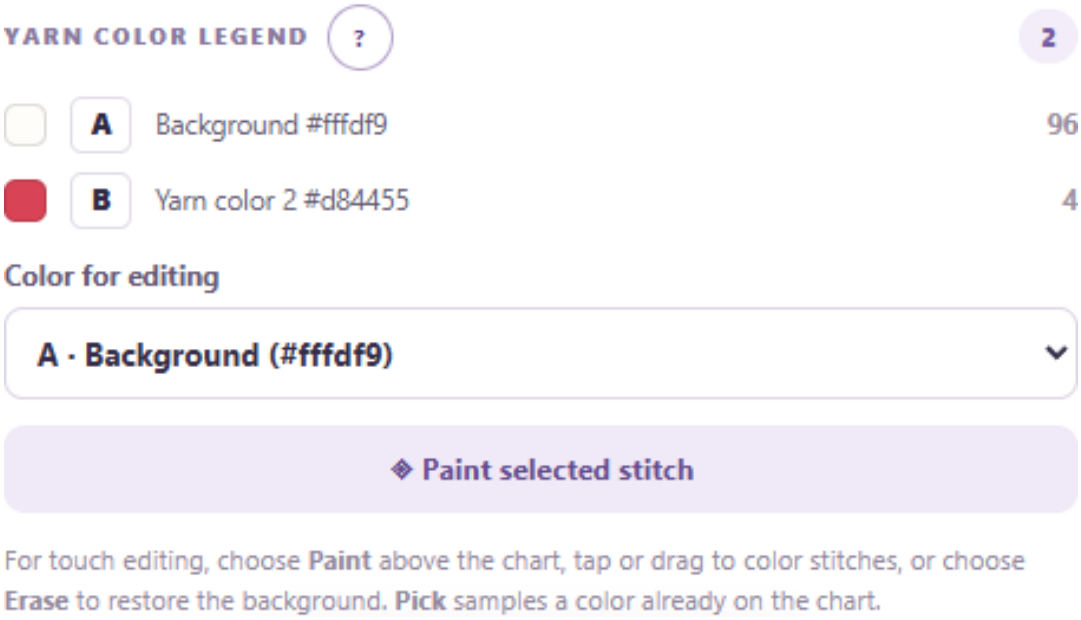
Clean up the picture
Clean printed artwork is intended for flat artwork and lettering using dark, light, red and blue. Natural image palette creates automatic colors. Adjust brightness, contrast, light text threshold, red/blue sensitivity and fine lettering boost. Reset cleanup restores the default cleanup settings.

Preview before applying
Choose yarn-color count and preview grid size, then Preview stitches. Both charts show the temporary result. Apply chart commits the conversion; Discard keeps the earlier stitch chart. Editing is paused during preview. Reference image opacity changes the photo overlay.

Compare sizes
Compare 79 x 117 vs 120 x 165 helps evaluate lettering detail. Choosing a size prepares a preview, which still needs Apply chart. A larger chart needs more stitches and yarn. Save a snapshot and ZIP before replacing an important design.

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Manage yarn colors



Read the legend
Each yarn has a color swatch, letter, name and stitch count. The same letters appear in the chart when zoomed enough, in row instruction chips and in exported PDFs.

Choose an editing color
Use a yarn swatch in the editor or the Color for editing list. Paint selected stitch changes the current selection. With Paint selected, tapping or dragging on the working chart applies that yarn.

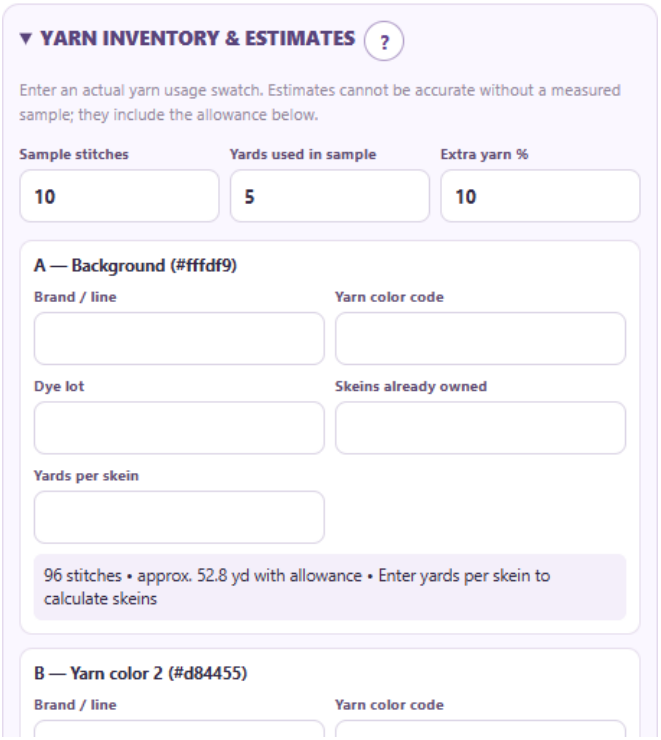
Add a yarn
Choose New color, then Add color. The app adds a new palette entry. Give your yarn inventory a useful brand and color-code record so the on-screen letter can be matched to the physical yarn.

Background and erasing
Erase uses the first yarn color. It does not create a transparent or missing stitch. Confirm which palette color is first before erasing large areas.

Counts and purchases
Counts update as the design changes. Color appearance varies by screen and print settings; use the recorded brand, color code and dye lot when matching or purchasing yarn.

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Estimate and record yarn



Measure your actual swatch
Enter Sample stitches and Yards used in sample from a swatch made with the yarn, hook and stitch technique you intend to use. Extra yarn % adds a planning allowance. Without a measured sample the estimate is not meaningful.

How the estimate works
The app divides sample yards by sample stitches, multiplies by the number of chart stitches in each color, then adds the allowance. Example: 10 sample stitches use 5 yards; a 100-stitch chart with 10% extra estimates 55 yards in total.

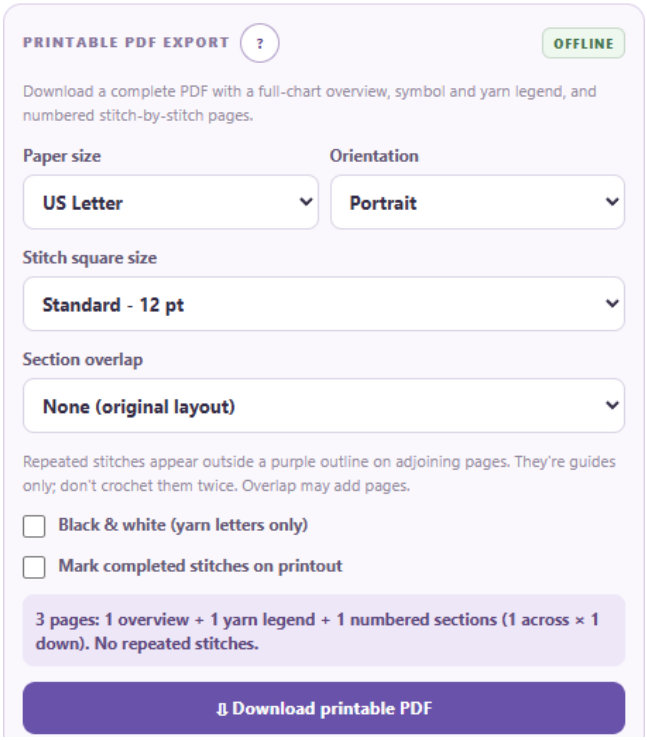
Record each yarn
For each color, enter brand/line, yarn color code, dye lot, skeins already owned and yards per skein. The app uses these to estimate total skeins and additional skeins needed. Enter yards per skein to enable that calculation.

Review after edits
Painting or changing chart dimensions changes stitch counts and estimates. Tension, yarn weight, technique, joins and finishing can alter real usage. Review the estimate against your actual project as you work.

Keep the details
Yarn records, gauge settings and snapshots save with the project and travel in its ZIP backup. Back up after entering a substantial inventory.

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Export chart and written PDFs



Printable chart PDF
Choose Letter or A4, portrait or landscape, and a stitch-square size. Larger squares are easier to read but need more pages. The estimate lists overview, legend and detail pages. Download printable PDF creates the file locally.

Page overlap
Section overlap repeats stitches around adjoining detail pages. The purple outline separates each page's main region from repeated edge stitches. Use overlap for alignment; do not crochet repeated stitches twice.

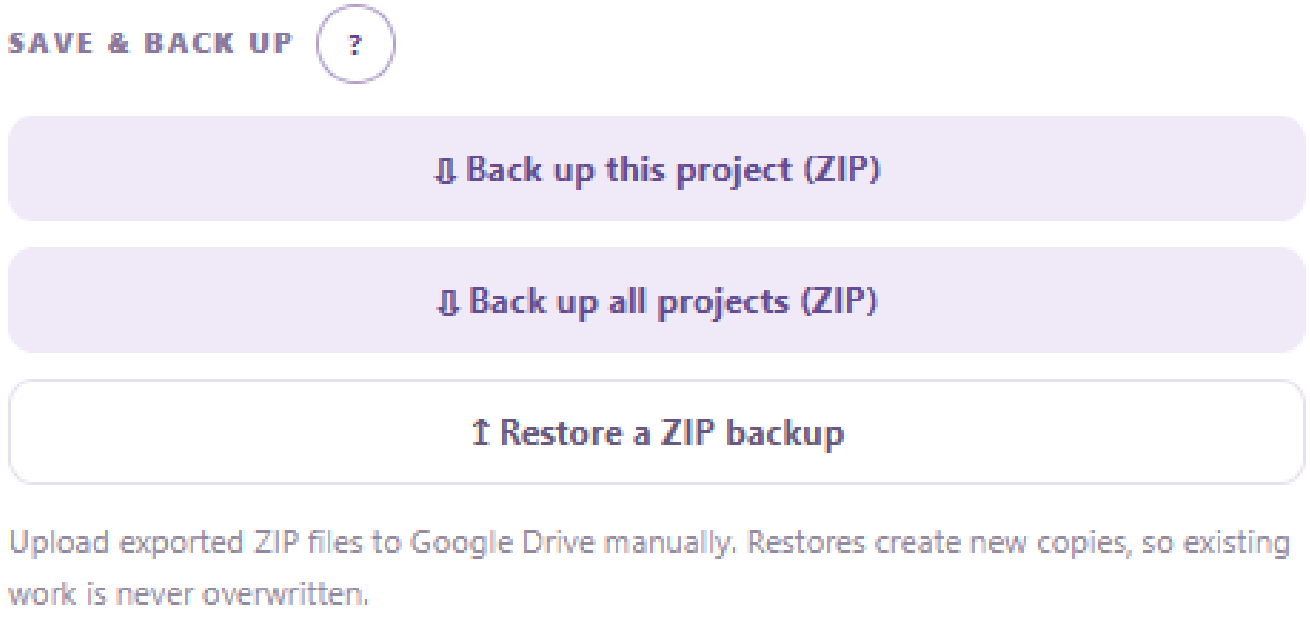
Other print options
Black & white uses yarn letters. Mark completed stitches on printout includes saved progress. The PDF includes an overview, yarn legend and numbered chart sections.

Written-pattern PDF
Download written instructions PDF creates consecutive yarn counts for every row, with working direction, yarn legend and row checkboxes. It uses the direction settings under Row-by-row color instructions and the saved chart; the source photo is not required.

Open your download
On a Samsung tablet, look in My Files, Downloads, then open the PDF. Check the first and last rows and yarn legend before printing. A pattern PDF is a viewing/printing document, not a restorable project backup.

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Saving and ZIP backups



Export regularly
Back up this project creates a ZIP for the current project. Back up all projects includes every saved project in this browser. Leave the ZIP intact and upload it manually to a private Google Drive folder. The app does not synchronize directly with Drive.

Restore a backup
Choose Restore backup or Restore a ZIP backup, then select the original Dorette ZIP. Restoring creates new project copies with restored in the name. Existing projects remain. Older v1.0.0 backups are supported; the portable backup format remains version 1.

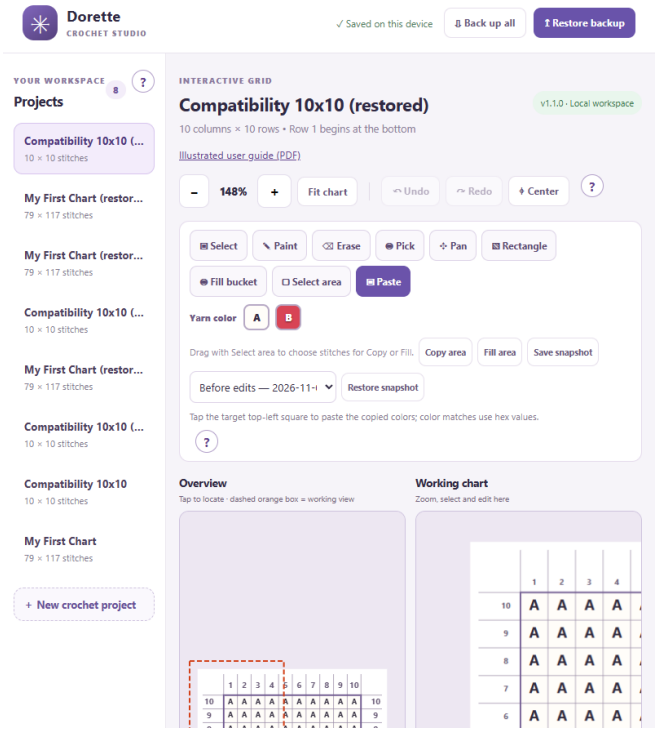
Verify your recovery
Open the restored copy and compare chart dimensions, yarn colors, completion, guide position, yarn inventory and snapshots. Retain the original project and the backup until you are satisfied.

What to keep
Keep a recent all-projects ZIP, separate backups of important milestones, and an application ZIP. An application/update ZIP contains the software; a project backup ZIP contains your work. Use the in-app Restore button only for project backups.

Storage care
Keep using the same browser profile and GitHub Pages address. Clearing browser/site storage or using a private browsing session can remove or isolate local work. On another device, restore a ZIP to bring your projects over. Delete current project is permanent after confirmation.

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Tablet use, help and troubleshooting



Responsive layout

On wide screens the overview is on the left and the working chart on the right. On compact screens they stack, with the overview above the working chart. Settings move below the workspace on tablets. Scroll the page to reach lower sections.

Touch and keyboard

Use one finger to select or paint with the chosen tool; use two fingers to pinch the working chart. Choose Pan to move the chart without painting. Tap the overview to recenter a zoomed view. A focused chart also accepts arrow-key selection.

Section help

Tap a ? button for a concise explanation beside that section. Tap it again to collapse it. Help does not block the charts or change project data. The Illustrated user guide link opens this PDF.

If a chart seems missing

Tap Fit chart. Check the selected project and whether a conversion preview needs Apply or Discard. If the source photo is missing, saved stitch colors still work; reimport the photo only when you need a fresh conversion.

If an update looks old

Wait for GitHub Pages deployment, close extra app tabs, then reload while online. Reopen the installed app after loading the updated website. Keep a ZIP backup. Do not clear site data as an update step. If saving fails, export immediately and use a normal browser window.

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Install the v1.1.0 update

1. Back up first
In the existing app, choose Back up all and save the project ZIP privately. Keep the earlier application ZIP too. Updating the app should preserve local work; a separate backup protects against device and browser problems.

2. Upload the update files
Extract the GitHub Update ZIP. Upload its contents into the root of the existing Dorette-Crochet-Studio repository on the branch currently used by GitHub Pages. Replace matching software files. Keep the same repository and Pages address.

3. Commit and wait
Commit the uploaded files and wait for the GitHub Pages deployment to finish. Open the usual site with ?v=110 appended. This query is only a refresh aid; it does not change the browser origin or create a new project database.

4. Verify the update
The workspace badge should read v1.1.0. Confirm that the overview, working chart and inline guide are visible. Open an existing project and check colors, progress and yarn details. New software caching replaces older app files without clearing IndexedDB or localStorage.

5. Test and resume
On a 10 x 10 practice chart, try painting, Undo/Redo, selection in both views, guide advancement and a ZIP backup/restore. Read the included release test report for automated coverage. A physical Samsung tablet check remains useful for touch behavior and downloads.

Package contents
GitHub Update contains deployable software, icons and this guide. Complete also includes source history details, update instructions, release notes and automated test evidence. Neither ZIP contains your private local projects.

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